

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Telecommunications English



Conversation lab

8 complete workplace dialogues, followed by eight additional role-play cases. Study the exchanges, then make the conversation your own.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For network operations staff, telecom engineers, field technicians, customer operations teams, product managers, regulatory staff, and telecom project leaders.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Inside this conversation lab

Original fictional training conversations in professional English. These are realistic scripts, not transcripts of actual people. The professional roles are the speaker labels; all figures, incidents, and organizations are invented.

01 Outage bridge

02 Fiber deployment dependency

03 Capacity or coverage?

04 Provisioning mismatch

05 Field dispatch handoff

06 Emergency-service change review

07 Churn-risk discussion

08 Equipment end of support

Then try eight independent role-play cases, followed by feedback criteria and references.

Read it. Hear it. Make it yours.

1. Read the setting. Identify the roles, the immediate problem, and what each speaker needs.
2. Read the whole conversation aloud with a partner. In a group, give a third person the observer role. For three-speaker scripts, assign each professional a separate voice.
3. Notice how the speakers ask a specific question, qualify a claim, disagree, explain a technical point, or agree on a next step. Underline language you would actually use.
4. Cover the script. Recreate the exchange using the situation and professional roles. Keep the meaning, but change the wording.
5. Switch roles and introduce a complication: a missing record, a different priority, an unavailable colleague, or a changed assumption. End with a clear outcome or unresolved question.

Register and terminology

These colleagues use concise professional language. In an internal technical meeting, familiar abbreviations can be natural. With a new colleague or a client, expand unfamiliar terms and check understanding. Keep disagreement directed at the evidence or proposal, and match the degree of certainty to what is known.

Independent study

Speak each role aloud. Pause before the reply and supply your own response before revealing the next line. Record a second version using invented details, then compare its clarity and tone with the script.

Professional context

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

FULL DIALOGUE 01 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Outage bridge

Network operations coordinates a service interruption.

Roles: NOC engineer / Incident coordinator

NOC engineer: We have loss-of-signal alarms on the eastern ring. Several enterprise circuits are affected.

Incident coordinator: Do we have a confirmed fault location or only correlated alarms?

NOC engineer: Only the alarms so far. Field verification is pending.

Incident coordinator: Keep the suspected cause separate from confirmed impact. Who owns field coordination?

NOC engineer: The duty field supervisor. I'll provide circuit IDs and the latest topology information.

Incident coordinator: I'll maintain the incident timeline and issue the next update without inventing a restoration time.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Do we have a confirmed fault location or only correlated alarms?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 02 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Fiber deployment dependency

A rollout team encounters a blocked construction segment.

Roles: Deployment manager / Civil works coordinator

Deployment manager: The fiber crew is booked for Monday. Is the duct route ready?

Civil works coordinator: Not on the final segment. The permit condition requires clarification before excavation proceeds.

Deployment manager: Can the crew complete an independent section instead?

Civil works coordinator: Yes, if the revised work package and access arrangements are approved.

Deployment manager: I'll resequence the plan and flag the blocked dependency.

Civil works coordinator: I'll pursue the permit clarification and confirm which sections are actually released for work.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The fiber crew is booked for Monday. Is the duct route ready?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 03 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Capacity or coverage?

Engineers investigate complaints in a busy area.

Roles: Radio engineer / Network planner

Radio engineer: Signal strength looks acceptable, but users report slow data during the evening peak.

Network planner: That could be capacity rather than coverage. What do utilization and throughput trends show?

Radio engineer: Utilization rises at the same times, but we still need to check backhaul and interference.

Network planner: Compare the affected cells with neighboring sites and the same time windows.

Radio engineer: I'll prepare the evidence before proposing additional capacity.

Network planner: Include the assumptions and constraints so we don't choose a remedy from signal strength alone.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "That could be capacity rather than coverage. What do utilization and throughput trends show?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 04 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Provisioning mismatch

A service activation fails despite a completed order status.

Roles: Provisioning specialist / Service delivery manager

Provisioning specialist: The order is marked complete, but the customer's circuit isn't passing the acceptance test.

Service delivery manager: Which stage failed: configuration, physical connectivity, or test validation?

Provisioning specialist: The port configuration doesn't match the approved service profile.

Service delivery manager: Route the correction through the authorized change process and retain the test results.

Provisioning specialist: I'll verify the configuration and repeat the agreed acceptance checks after the change.

Service delivery manager: I'll keep customer acceptance pending and explain the next confirmed step to the account team.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "Which stage failed: configuration, physical connectivity, or test validation?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 05 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Field dispatch handoff

A technician receives an incomplete fault ticket.

Roles: Field technician / Dispatch coordinator

Field technician: I have the site address, but no access contact or equipment reference.

Dispatch coordinator: I'll obtain both before confirming the visit. The ticket currently lists only the customer's billing address.

Field technician: Please also confirm whether any access restrictions or hazards are recorded.

Dispatch coordinator: I'll check the work order and required site arrangements.

Field technician: Once those are complete, I can assess the tools and skills needed for the job.

Dispatch coordinator: I'll update the ticket and send you the verified work location before dispatch.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "I have the site address, but no access contact or equipment reference." What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 06 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Emergency-service change review

A network change has potential emergency-service implications.

Roles: Change manager / Compliance specialist

Change manager: This routing change affects a service used for emergency calling. Can it follow the ordinary release schedule?

Compliance specialist: It needs the applicable specialist review, testing, and coordination before approval.

Change manager: The current change record doesn't identify that dependency.

Compliance specialist: Add the affected services and ask the responsible engineering team to define the required evidence.

Change manager: I'll keep implementation pending and update the review group.

Compliance specialist: Record the approval conditions clearly; a successful general connectivity test isn't enough to close this issue.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "This routing change affects a service used for emergency calling. Can it follow the ordinary release schedule?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 07 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Churn-risk discussion

A service manager responds to a customer's repeated interruptions.

Roles: Account manager / Service assurance lead

Account manager: The customer is considering leaving after three outages. Can we promise there won't be another?

Service assurance lead: No. We can explain the confirmed incidents, completed improvements, and remaining work accurately.

Account manager: They also want a service-credit review.

Service assurance lead: Route that against the actual agreement and incident records; don't promise an amount before review.

Account manager: I'll arrange a meeting around the recovery actions and communication plan.

Service assurance lead: I'll bring the evidence and identify who owns each outstanding reliability action.

Notice the professional language

Discuss this wording: "The customer is considering leaving after three outages. Can we promise there won't be another?" What does it help the other professional clarify?

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

FULL DIALOGUE 08 / 6 SPEAKING TURNS

Equipment end of support

A network team plans replacement of aging equipment.

Roles: Network planner / Vendor manager

Network planner: The router family reaches end of support next year. Does that mean it stops operating then?

Vendor manager: No, but the vendor's support and update arrangements change. We need to verify the exact notice and dates.

Network planner: I'll map installed units and service dependencies.

Vendor manager: I'll confirm replacement options, lead times, and contractual support conditions.

Network planner: Then we can prioritize migration by exposure and business impact.

Vendor manager: Include test, rollback, and maintenance-window requirements in the plan before committing customer dates.

Notice the professional language

end of support - The point after which a supplier stops providing specified support for a product.

Rehearse and extend with AI

Explain the issue and the agreed next step without reading. Identify any point still awaiting evidence, agreement, or approval. Then replay the exchange with a changed constraint and a new ending.

Observer: note one natural professional expression and one place where the follow-up made the meaning clearer.

Eight more situations to make your own

The following cases are open role plays. They give you facts, contrasting roles, useful expressions, and a short model response. Use what you learned from the complete dialogues to create a longer exchange.

Preparation: two minutes. Conversation: three to five minutes. Feedback: one minute. Switch roles and repeat with the second-round challenge.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 01

Network Operations and Outage Bridges

SHARED CASE

A network incident affects one service area. Fault isolation is ongoing, and no restoration estimate has been verified.

Role A | Responding professional

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Useful expressions

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Cover this until after your first attempt

The affected area is identified, and fault isolation is continuing. We do not yet have a verified restoration estimate. I'll state the next update time and revise the message when confirmed information is available.

Second round

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 02

Fiber Deployment and Construction Coordination

SHARED CASE

A fiber installation team has completed physical work but an inspection is still pending. The next team assumes the route is ready.

Role A | Responding professional

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Useful expressions

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Cover this until after your first attempt

Physical installation is complete; the inspection remains pending. Please confirm the approved status before scheduling the next activity, and record the outstanding item in the handoff.

Second round

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 03

Wireless Capacity and Coverage

SHARED CASE

Customers report slow service in a busy area even though the coverage map shows signal availability.

Role A | Responding professional

Explain a useful distinction in plain English. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Useful expressions

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Coverage and capacity describe different issues. A signal may be available while busy-period demand affects performance. I'll explain that distinction and report the observed conditions for investigation.

Second round

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 04

Provisioning and Service Activation

SHARED CASE

A service-activation request has a customer address but no circuit reference or requested activation date.

Role A | Responding professional

Clarify missing information before responding. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Useful expressions

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you confirm the circuit reference and target activation date? We need to match the request to the correct service and distinguish the requested date from a confirmed appointment.

Second round

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 05

Field Service and Dispatch

SHARED CASE

A field technician receives a ticket that says only "internet bad." The customer is available for a clarification call.

Role A | Responding professional

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Useful expressions

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Cover this until after your first attempt

Could you describe what happens, when it occurs, and which devices are affected? Those details will help the field team prepare for the visit and avoid assumptions about the cause.

Second round

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 06

Regulatory and Emergency Services

SHARED CASE

A customer notice describes a regulatory requirement without citing the current approved wording. The responsible team has not reviewed it.

Role A | Responding professional

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Useful expressions

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Cover this until after your first attempt

The notice needs review against the current applicable requirement and approved language. I'll identify the disputed wording and route it to the responsible team before release.

Second round

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 07

Customer Churn and Service Recovery

SHARED CASE

A customer asks for an update after repeated service interruptions. The investigation has no confirmed root cause.

Role A | Responding professional

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Useful expressions

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Cover this until after your first attempt

I'm sorry the interruptions have continued. The cause is still under investigation. I'll summarize the verified service history and confirm the next update rather than repeat an unverified explanation.

Second round

The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

ROLE-PLAY CASE 08

Vendor and Equipment Lifecycle

SHARED CASE

One equipment proposal has a lower purchase price but an earlier end-of-support date. The replacement plan extends beyond that date.

Role A | Responding professional

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff. Use only the facts given. Choose two relevant terms and be ready to explain one of them in ordinary words.

Role B | Listener

You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Useful expressions

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Cover this until after your first attempt

The lower price comes with a shorter support period. Let's compare the expected service life, support needs, and replacement timing before making the investment recommendation.

Second round

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Debrief and extend with AI

Which phrase helped the listener? Which case fact needed clarification? Write one better follow-up question, then repeat the exchange.

Lesson conversations and speaking practice

The following sections match 05 and 06 on the industry webpage and in the learner workbook. Each lesson has three ten-turn conversations and two bounded speaking scenarios. These are original fictional teaching scripts, not transcripts of real people.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

No verified restoration estimate

The lesson's outage bridge covers one affected service area; fault isolation continues and no restoration estimate has been verified.

01 • NOC analyst: The outage affects one service area. Fault isolation is ongoing, and we have no verified restoration estimate.

02 • Service manager: Can I tell customer support that service will probably return within the next hour?

03 • NOC analyst: We don't have evidence for that timing. Please don't turn a possible duration into an ETA.

04 • Service manager: Understood. What progress can I describe without suggesting the fault has already been found?

05 • NOC analyst: Say that the network operations center is investigating the affected area; the cause remains unconfirmed.

06 • Service manager: Should support describe other areas as unaffected, or would that extend beyond the information we have?

07 • NOC analyst: Use the confirmed scope. Don't make broader claims unless the monitoring team has checked them.

08 • Service manager: I'll separate confirmed impact, investigation status, and the missing restoration estimate in the update.

09 • NOC analyst: Good. I'll pass on verified changes through this bridge rather than speculate about the repair.

10 • Service manager: I'll make clear that the next status update is not a promise of restoration.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Alarms cleared, customer checks pending

Separate fictional case: alarms on a business-access node have cleared after a recovery action, but customer-level service checks have not finished.

01 • Incident coordinator: The node alarms have cleared after the recovery action. Customer service checks are still underway.

02 • Service assurance engineer: Then should we close the outage ticket, or does the remaining verification affect closure?

03 • Incident coordinator: It matters. Cleared alarms show one improvement, but we haven't confirmed the customer experience yet.

04 • Service assurance engineer: I'll keep the service check open and avoid describing the outage as fully resolved.

05 • Incident coordinator: Can you tell the support lead exactly what has changed since the last bridge update?

06 • Service assurance engineer: The network alarms cleared; customer-level verification remains pending. We have not established a root cause.

07 • Incident coordinator: That distinction is useful. Please don't imply that the recovery action proves what caused the fault.

08 • Service assurance engineer: Agreed. I'll record the action and observed result without presenting the sequence as causal proof.

09 • Incident coordinator: Bring the verification results back to the bridge when they are available, including any remaining failures.

10 • Service assurance engineer: I will. Closure can then be considered against the actual results and our incident process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A monitoring gap after maintenance

Separate fictional case: after planned maintenance, traffic counters are visible but latency telemetry is missing; no customer outage has been confirmed.

01 • Shift supervisor: We can see traffic counters again, but the latency telemetry has not returned after maintenance.

02 • NOC engineer: Does that mean customers are experiencing an outage, or only that our visibility is incomplete?

03 • Shift supervisor: We have confirmed the monitoring gap, not a customer outage. Service impact still needs checking.

04 • NOC engineer: I'll describe the missing telemetry separately from the available traffic data in the handover.

05 • Shift supervisor: Please also identify which checks remain open so the next shift doesn't assume monitoring is complete.

06 • NOC engineer: The telemetry investigation and customer-impact check remain open. Neither has a confirmed completion time yet.

07 • Shift supervisor: Could the maintenance be the cause, given that the gap appeared afterward?

08 • NOC engineer: It may be related, but the timing alone doesn't establish that. We'll examine the change records.

09 • Shift supervisor: Good. Keep the status precise and avoid giving a restoration ETA for an unconfirmed service failure.

10 • NOC engineer: I'll report the monitoring recovery and service findings separately as the evidence becomes available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Network Operations and Outage Bridges

A network incident affects one service area. Fault isolation is ongoing, and no restoration estimate has been verified.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The affected area is identified, and fault isolation is continuing. We do not yet have a verified restoration estimate. I'll state the next update time and revise the message when confirmed information is available.

Scenario 2 | A dashboard with stale timestamps

In a fictional operations center, a dashboard displays green status but its last update was forty minutes ago. A separate ticket reports connection failures at one branch. Give a status update without treating the dashboard as current evidence.

Role A: You are the NOC analyst. Explain the stale timestamp and outstanding verification.

Role B: You are the incident manager. Ask what is known about branch impact and who will check it.

Possible opening: The dashboard is green, but its data is forty minutes old, so current service status is not verified.

Success checks

- Distinguish displayed status from current verified status.
- Keep the reported branch failure separate from confirmed wider impact.
- Agree checks for both monitoring freshness and the branch report.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to dismiss the branch ticket because there is no red alarm.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Physical completion is not inspection clearance

The lesson's fiber installation is physically complete but inspection remains pending; the receiving team assumes the route is ready.

01 • Construction coordinator: The physical fiber work is complete, but inspection is still pending. I'm handing over an incomplete readiness status.

02 • Activation supervisor: Our team thought the route was ready. Are you asking us to begin service activation?

03 • Construction coordinator: No. I'm asking you to acknowledge the physical completion and the outstanding inspection separately.

04 • Activation supervisor: Understood. Who will provide the inspection result so we know when to reconsider the next stage?

05 • Construction coordinator: I'll coordinate that update with the inspection owner. I don't yet have a confirmed result or timing.

06 • Activation supervisor: Should we also verify the handover records for splicing and any relevant permit conditions?

07 • Construction coordinator: Yes. Use the actual records rather than inferring their status from physical completion.

08 • Activation supervisor: I'll keep the receiving task pending and tell my team that route readiness is not confirmed.

09 • Construction coordinator: Please repeat the main dependency when you brief them, so the distinction survives the handoff.

10 • Activation supervisor: Physical work is complete; inspection and readiness verification remain outstanding. We await your evidence-based update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Splice records and the wrong route label

Separate fictional case: a fiber handover package names route F12, while its splice diagram is labeled F21; neither team knows which label is correct.

01 • Field coordinator: This handover names route F12, but the attached splice diagram says F21. The route identity needs checking.

02 • Network records specialist: Could that be a typing error, or are we looking at two different fiber routes?

03 • Field coordinator: Either is possible. I can't confirm which, so please don't relabel the diagram on an assumption.

04 • Network records specialist: I'll hold the records update and compare the source package with the project references.

05 • Field coordinator: I'll contact the construction lead for the verified route identifier and the corresponding splicing record.

06 • Network records specialist: What should I tell the provisioning team if they ask whether the documentation is ready?

07 • Field coordinator: Say the package was received but contains an unresolved identity mismatch. Receipt doesn't mean acceptance.

08 • Network records specialist: Understood. My task is document verification, and yours is obtaining confirmation from construction.

09 • Field coordinator: Correct. Once we reconcile the identifiers, I'll send a clearly versioned replacement handover package.

10 • Network records specialist: I'll acknowledge the corrected package and confirm which records have actually been updated.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Make-ready ownership at a shared site

Separate fictional case: a project uses make-ready to mean site preparation. The civil contractor has completed the duct inspection; the building-access confirmation remains with the property team.

01 • Civil works coordinator: The duct inspection is complete. Building access remains unconfirmed, and the property team owns that check.

02 • Fiber deployment lead: Our schedule says make-ready complete. Does that label include building access in this project?

03 • Civil works coordinator: It should not imply that all preparation is finished. Only the duct inspection is complete here.

04 • Fiber deployment lead: I'll correct our readiness summary before the installation crew receives its assignment.

05 • Civil works coordinator: Please carry forward the access dependency and the property team's responsibility in your handover.

06 • Fiber deployment lead: Can you transfer the completed inspection record while I contact the property coordinator?

07 • Civil works coordinator: Yes. I'll send the identified record, but I cannot authorize site entry on their behalf.

08 • Fiber deployment lead: Understood. Receiving the inspection record doesn't give the crew permission to enter the building.

09 • Civil works coordinator: Exactly. Let me know whether the property team accepts ownership of the access confirmation.

10 • Fiber deployment lead: I'll obtain that acknowledgment and keep crew scheduling conditional on the remaining project checks.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Fiber Deployment and Construction Coordination

A fiber installation team has completed physical work but an inspection is still pending. The next team assumes the route is ready.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: Physical installation is complete; the inspection remains pending. Please confirm the approved status before scheduling the next activity, and record the outstanding item in the handoff.

Scenario 2 | An incomplete test attachment

A fictional fiber handover includes installation photographs and a test-results attachment that cannot be opened. The installation coordinator has the original file; the receiving engineer has not reviewed its results. Conduct a handoff and agree how to resolve the missing evidence.

Role A: You are the installation coordinator. Explain what was sent and arrange a readable replacement.

Role B: You are the receiving engineer. Confirm receipt of the photographs but not acceptance of unseen test results.

Possible opening: You have the installation photographs, but I understand the test attachment did not open.

Success checks

- Separate email receipt from technical acceptance.
- Assign responsibility for resending and reviewing the test record.
- Read back the outstanding acceptance dependency.

Add a complication: The project manager wants the handover marked accepted because the email was delivered.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Signal on the map, slow service on the street

The lesson's customers report slow wireless service in a busy area despite mapped signal coverage.

01 • Customer operations lead: Our map shows coverage in the busy area. Why are customers still reporting slow service?

02 • Radio planner: Coverage describes signal availability. Capacity concerns how much demand the network can handle in the relevant conditions.

03 • Customer operations lead: So a coverage map doesn't promise that every user will get the same speed?

04 • Radio planner: Correct. Think of reaching the network and sharing its available resources as different questions.

05 • Customer operations lead: Could congestion explain these reports, or would saying that overstate what we've checked?

06 • Radio planner: It is a possible explanation, not a confirmed diagnosis. We need measurements from the reported times and locations.

07 • Customer operations lead: I'll ask support to capture those details instead of answering every report with the coverage map.

08 • Radio planner: Good. Also avoid saying that adding spectrum automatically resolves this particular problem; we haven't assessed it.

09 • Customer operations lead: My explanation will distinguish having a signal from having sufficient resources during busy periods.

10 • Radio planner: Exactly. Then we can investigate the reports without treating mapped coverage as proof of service performance.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An empty venue test is not an event test

Separate fictional case: a wireless demonstration worked in an empty exhibition hall; the organizer asks whether that proves performance during a crowded event.

01 • Event connectivity manager: The demonstration worked in the empty hall. Can we promise the same experience when visitors arrive?

02 • Wireless engineer: The test shows performance under that test load, not under the expected event demand.

03 • Event connectivity manager: Is that the distinction between coverage and capacity, even though the building stays the same?

04 • Wireless engineer: Yes. The signal may reach the space while many simultaneous users create a different capacity requirement.

05 • Event connectivity manager: Then a successful connection at every stand doesn't establish how well shared service will perform.

06 • Wireless engineer: Exactly. We need an agreed demand profile and a suitable assessment before making event claims.

07 • Event connectivity manager: What should I explain to exhibitors who heard that the wireless test passed?

08 • Wireless engineer: Say the empty-hall connectivity test passed; performance under event load has not yet been verified.

09 • Event connectivity manager: I'll clarify that distinction and collect the expected use cases rather than inventing a guaranteed speed.

10 • Wireless engineer: I'll use those requirements to propose the next assessment and explain its limits in plain language.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Indoor reception and shared capacity

Separate fictional case: office users report weak reception in a basement and slow downloads at lunchtime upstairs; neither symptom has been diagnosed.

01 • Facilities manager: Staff describe both problems as poor coverage: weak basement reception and slow lunchtime downloads upstairs.

02 • Radio engineer: Those reports may involve different issues. Coverage and capacity are related, but they aren't interchangeable labels.

03 • Facilities manager: Could you explain the difference without assuming either problem has already been diagnosed?

04 • Radio engineer: Weak reception concerns signal availability at a location. Slow downloads can have several causes, including shared demand.

05 • Facilities manager: So the basement report suggests a signal question, while lunchtime suggests a time-dependent performance question?

06 • Radio engineer: Yes, as investigation directions, not findings. We still need measurements and the affected service details.

07 • Facilities manager: Would moving upstairs solve the lunchtime problem if people can already see a strong signal there?

08 • Radio engineer: We can't conclude that. A signal indicator doesn't measure every factor affecting the download experience.

09 • Facilities manager: I'll keep the location and timing reports separate when I ask staff for examples.

10 • Radio engineer: That will help us investigate coverage and possible congestion without forcing both symptoms into one explanation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Wireless Capacity and Coverage

Customers report slow service in a busy area even though the coverage map shows signal availability.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Coverage and capacity describe different issues. A signal may be available while busy-period demand affects performance. I'll explain that distinction and report the observed conditions for investigation.

Scenario 2 | More bars after a handset change

In a fictional office, one employee's new handset shows more signal bars, but no controlled speed or call-quality comparison has been made. Discuss what the observation does and does not establish.

Role A: You are the support supervisor. Ask whether the handset proves the network has gained capacity.

Role B: You are the radio analyst. Explain indicator readings versus measured service performance in ordinary language.

Possible opening: More signal bars on one handset do not establish that the network now has more capacity.

Success checks

- Distinguish an indicator from a controlled service measurement.
- Avoid diagnosing the handset or network from one observation.
- Agree a comparable test before making a wider recommendation.

Add a complication: The supervisor wants to recommend replacing every handset based on this observation.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An address does not identify the circuit

The lesson's service-activation request includes an address but lacks a circuit reference and requested activation date.

01 • Provisioning specialist: I have the customer address, but which circuit does this service-activation request concern?

02 • Account coordinator: The request doesn't contain a circuit reference. I need to obtain it from the customer owner.

03 • Provisioning specialist: Please confirm that identifier before we match the request to a service at the address.

04 • Account coordinator: Could we use the address alone and add the circuit reference after activation?

05 • Provisioning specialist: That leaves the service identity unresolved. We should clarify it before planning the activation work.

06 • Account coordinator: Understood. You also need the requested activation date, which is missing from the request.

07 • Provisioning specialist: Correct. Please distinguish the customer's preferred date from any date our delivery team has confirmed.

08 • Account coordinator: Should I ask about the CPE as well, meaning the equipment at the customer's premises?

09 • Provisioning specialist: Yes, obtain the relevant equipment details through the normal intake process rather than assuming readiness.

10 • Account coordinator: I'll return with the circuit reference, requested date, and available equipment information, with any gaps clearly marked.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Replacing equipment or adding service?

Separate fictional case: an order says upgrade at branch B7 and names an existing circuit; it does not say whether the customer wants new premises equipment or a service change.

01 • Order manager: The order says upgrade for circuit B7. Does that mean replacing CPE or changing the service?

02 • Customer technical lead: I can see why that's unclear. Our internal note uses upgrade without specifying the desired outcome.

03 • Order manager: Could you clarify what should be different for users after the work is completed?

04 • Customer technical lead: I need to check with our network owner rather than guess which change they intended.

05 • Order manager: Please do. Equipment replacement and service provisioning could require different information and coordination.

06 • Customer technical lead: Should I also confirm whether the existing service is expected to remain available during the work?

07 • Order manager: Yes. State that as a requirement for review, not as something we have already guaranteed.

08 • Customer technical lead: Understood. I won't tell the branch that an activation date has been agreed yet.

09 • Order manager: Once the requested change is clear, we can identify the appropriate planning and approval steps.

10 • Customer technical lead: I'll clarify the outcome with our network owner and return with a specific request.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Which date is the requested date?

Separate fictional case: a provisioning form shows delivery on the tenth and activation on the twelfth; the customer's email asks for service on the tenth.

01 • Activation coordinator: Your email requests service on the tenth, but the form lists activation on the twelfth.

02 • Customer project manager: The tenth is when equipment is due. I may have used service too broadly in the email.

03 • Activation coordinator: Could you confirm whether you need usable connectivity on the tenth or only equipment delivery?

04 • Customer project manager: I need to verify that with the branch team before I give you a firm requirement.

05 • Activation coordinator: Thank you. Delivery and service activation are separate milestones, and neither date is confirmed by this form alone.

06 • Customer project manager: Can we leave the twelfth in the plan while I check the branch's actual need?

07 • Activation coordinator: Yes, labeled as requested and under review. I won't present it as a confirmed activation slot.

08 • Customer project manager: I'll also make sure the branch understands that receiving CPE doesn't mean the circuit is live.

09 • Activation coordinator: Good. Please return with the required usable-service date, so we can assess the provisioning dependencies.

10 • Customer project manager: I'll clarify that requirement and keep the delivery date distinct when I brief everyone.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Provisioning and Service Activation

A service-activation request has a customer address but no circuit reference or requested activation date.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Could you confirm the circuit reference and target activation date? We need to match the request to the correct service and distinguish the requested date from a confirmed appointment.

Scenario 2 | Two suites at one address

A fictional activation request identifies a building containing suites 2A and 2B, but gives no suite number. The customer leases both, and only one needs the new circuit. Clarify the destination before provisioning proceeds.

Role A: You are the provisioning coordinator. Ask which suite and service reference the request concerns.

Role B: You are the customer's office manager. You know both suites exist but must check the destination with the IT owner.

Possible opening: Could you confirm which suite needs the new circuit? The building address identifies two possible locations.

Success checks

- Ask for the exact destination without guessing.
- Identify the customer owner who can confirm it.
- Keep service planning conditional on the correct location and reference.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests choosing 2A because that suite appears first in the customer record.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Turn internet bad into a usable dispatch request

The lesson's field ticket says only internet bad; the customer is available for a clarification call.

01 • Field technician: Could you arrange a customer clarification call? The ticket says internet bad but doesn't describe the symptoms.

02 • Dispatch coordinator: What information would help you prepare without asking the customer to troubleshoot unfamiliar equipment?

03 • Field technician: Please ask what stops working, when it happens, and whether it affects one device or several.

04 • Dispatch coordinator: Should I ask them to inspect inside wiring before we schedule a truck roll?

05 • Field technician: No. Start with their observations and follow our approved support process for any additional checks.

06 • Dispatch coordinator: They are available now. I can ask those questions and capture their answers in the ticket.

07 • Field technician: Thank you. Include their availability for a visit, but don't promise a repair time or diagnosis.

08 • Dispatch coordinator: Would you like me to request the existing signal-level records from service support as well?

09 • Field technician: Yes, if available through the normal channel. That would help distinguish measured information from reported symptoms.

10 • Dispatch coordinator: I'll collect the observations and available records, then confirm what dispatch can arrange.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Site access before a truck roll

Separate fictional case: a technician is assigned to a locked equipment room, but the dispatch ticket has no authorized site contact.

01 • Field supervisor: Please obtain an authorized site contact before confirming this truck roll to the locked equipment room.

02 • Dispatch planner: The address is complete. Why can't the technician simply ask reception for access on arrival?

03 • Field supervisor: We haven't established that reception can authorize access. The visit needs a confirmed contact and arrangement.

04 • Dispatch planner: I'll ask the customer's facilities coordinator who can meet the technician and arrange the approved access.

05 • Field supervisor: Please include the person's work contact details through the ticket system, not in a public chat.

06 • Dispatch planner: Should I keep the proposed visit time or offer a different slot while I ask?

07 • Field supervisor: Ask whether the proposed time works. Don't describe it as confirmed until the required coordination is complete.

08 • Dispatch planner: Understood. This request concerns access readiness, not permission to bypass the locked room's controls.

09 • Field supervisor: Exactly. A useful dispatch request includes what the technician needs and why it matters.

10 • Dispatch planner: I'll obtain the access arrangement and report any remaining obstacle before confirming the visit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A repeat visit needs the earlier evidence

Separate fictional case: a second technician is assigned to intermittent connection drops; the first visit's signal readings are mentioned in a ticket but not attached.

01 • Field technician: Could you retrieve the first visit's signal readings before we prepare this repeat service visit?

02 • Service coordinator: The ticket says readings taken, but it doesn't include the values or measurement conditions.

03 • Field technician: Please ask the original technician for the recorded results, including the time and measurement location.

04 • Service coordinator: Would it be enough to summarize the visit as signal normal? That's what the customer remembers.

05 • Field technician: That is a reported recollection, not the measurement record. We need to preserve the distinction.

06 • Service coordinator: I'll request the actual record and note that the customer's account is separate evidence.

07 • Field technician: Also ask whether any inside-wiring observations were recorded, without implying they explain the current drops.

08 • Service coordinator: I can request both sets of notes. I can't promise the original technician will respond before dispatch.

09 • Field technician: Then tell dispatch what remains missing, so the next visit isn't planned around assumed findings.

10 • Service coordinator: I'll send the available evidence and a clear list of outstanding questions to the receiving technician.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Field Service and Dispatch

A field technician receives a ticket that says only "internet bad." The customer is available for a clarification call.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you describe what happens, when it occurs, and which devices are affected? Those details will help the field team prepare for the visit and avoid assumptions about the cause.

Scenario 2 | The symptom disappears before the visit

A fictional customer reports that intermittent calls are working again before a scheduled visit. No cause has been found and no cancellation has been agreed. Discuss what observations to request and who should decide the dispatch status.

Role A: You are the service coordinator. Request the latest symptom timing and customer availability.

Role B: You are the field supervisor. Explain what information you need before reviewing the visit plan.

Possible opening: Could you confirm when the calls started working again and whether any interruptions have happened since?

Success checks

- Request specific observations rather than declare the fault resolved.
- Distinguish a successful call from an established repair.
- Agree who will review the dispatch decision under the normal process.

Add a complication: Someone wants to cancel the visit automatically because the latest call succeeded.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Unreviewed wording in a customer notice

The lesson's customer notice describes a regulatory requirement without current approved wording or review by the responsible team.

01 • Customer communications editor: This customer notice describes a regulatory requirement, but I can't find the current approved wording.

02 • Regulatory coordinator: Then we shouldn't present the statement as verified. The responsible team hasn't reviewed this draft yet.

03 • Customer communications editor: Could I keep the wording and add that requirements may vary, as a temporary solution?

04 • Regulatory coordinator: A general caveat doesn't establish that the specific claim is correct. We need the appropriate review.

05 • Customer communications editor: I'll mark that section pending and ask for the source and applicable customer scope.

06 • Regulatory coordinator: Good. Keep any E911 or emergency-service description tied to the reviewed service and context.

07 • Customer communications editor: So I should not borrow language from another notice just because the service names look similar?

08 • Regulatory coordinator: Correct. We haven't confirmed that the wording applies here or that the older notice is current.

09 • Customer communications editor: I'll route the draft with the unresolved claims identified rather than publish an unsupported explanation.

10 • Regulatory coordinator: I'll obtain the responsible team's response and distinguish approved wording from questions still under review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A filed document is not a confirmed approval

Separate fictional case: a project tracker shows a regulatory filing submitted; no response from the reviewing body has been recorded.

01 • Program manager: The regulatory filing is submitted. Can the status slide say approval complete for the launch meeting?

02 • Regulatory affairs specialist: No. Submission is recorded, but we have no recorded response from the reviewing body.

03 • Program manager: I thought filing meant that the necessary regulatory step had been accepted.

04 • Regulatory affairs specialist: Here, it means the document was sent. We must check the actual process before claiming acceptance or approval.

05 • Program manager: Then I'll state submitted and leave the review outcome unresolved in the project status.

06 • Regulatory affairs specialist: Please also avoid assuming that submission alone establishes permission for any customer-facing change.

07 • Program manager: Could you identify which confirmation the project needs next, using the applicable internal guidance?

08 • Regulatory affairs specialist: Yes. I'll check with the responsible reviewer and report the required next step.

09 • Program manager: That gives us a factual update without inventing a legal conclusion or a response date.

10 • Regulatory affairs specialist: Exactly. We'll keep the filing record separate from whatever decision or acknowledgment follows.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A sensitive inquiry is not a validated instruction

Separate fictional case: a sales inbox receives a message labeled lawful intercept inquiry; the sender's authority and the request's applicability have not been verified.

01 • Sales operations lead: We received an email labeled lawful intercept inquiry. Should I tell the customer we'll comply immediately?

02 • Compliance liaison: No. The label doesn't establish the sender's authority, authenticity, or what action is applicable.

03 • Sales operations lead: I won't interpret the request. Which facts can I state when I escalate it?

04 • Compliance liaison: State that the email was received and that validation is pending. Use the designated restricted review channel.

05 • Sales operations lead: Should I forward the full message to the general account team so everyone is informed?

06 • Compliance liaison: Keep access limited through our established process. Don't spread potentially sensitive details unnecessarily.

07 • Sales operations lead: Understood. I can record receipt without describing the message as a verified legal demand.

08 • Compliance liaison: Exactly. The authorized team needs to assess it before anyone makes commitments or takes action.

09 • Sales operations lead: I'll route it for review and avoid customer-facing claims about our obligations or response timing.

10 • Compliance liaison: I'll confirm receipt by the responsible team while keeping the substantive outcome explicitly unresolved.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Regulatory and Emergency Services

A customer notice describes a regulatory requirement without citing the current approved wording. The responsible team has not reviewed it.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The notice needs review against the current applicable requirement and approved language. I'll identify the disputed wording and route it to the responsible team before release.

Scenario 2 | An old emergency-service slide

A fictional sales deck contains an emergency-service slide copied from an older product. The current product and customer location differ, and no specialist review has occurred. Discuss how to qualify the deck's readiness without giving emergency-service guidance.

Role A: You are the sales enablement lead. Identify the unverified claims before the presentation.

Role B: You are the regulatory liaison. Request review against the current product and applicable context.

Possible opening: This slide comes from another product, so its emergency-service claims are not yet verified for this presentation.

Success checks

- Distinguish prior use from current applicability.
- Avoid asserting a regulatory requirement or service capability.
- Agree to obtain authorized wording before using the claims.

Add a complication: A presenter says the slide has been used before and therefore must be safe to reuse.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Correcting a premature root-cause message

The lesson's customer asks about repeated service interruptions; the investigation has no confirmed root cause.

01 • Service assurance manager: I need to correct our earlier message. We described a cause before the investigation had confirmed it.

02 • Customer IT manager: That made us think the repeated interruptions were understood. What can you actually tell us now?

03 • Service assurance manager: The investigation remains open, and the root cause is not confirmed. I'm sorry our wording suggested otherwise.

04 • Customer IT manager: Can you at least promise the interruptions won't happen again after the next check?

05 • Service assurance manager: I can't make that promise from the current evidence. I can give you verified findings as they emerge.

06 • Customer IT manager: Please separate the investigation from any discussion of an SLA credit. We need clarity on both.

07 • Service assurance manager: Agreed. Credit eligibility needs the applicable service agreement and review; it isn't established by this conversation.

08 • Customer IT manager: A consistent contact would help. We keep having to explain the same history to different people.

09 • Service assurance manager: I'll coordinate the service assurance updates and confirm the contact arrangement through our account team.

10 • Customer IT manager: Thank you. Accurate updates will be more useful than another confident explanation that later changes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An update time was mistaken for a repair time

Separate fictional case: a support email promised an update at three; its subject line said service restored at three, but no restoration time is confirmed.

01 • Account service lead: Our subject line was wrong: three o'clock is the next update time, not a confirmed repair time.

02 • Customer operations manager: We arranged work around that subject line. The correction changes what our staff can plan.

03 • Account service lead: I understand, and I'm sorry for the misleading wording. Restoration timing is still unconfirmed.

04 • Customer operations manager: Will your next message actually contain a fix, or might it just report that investigation continues?

05 • Account service lead: It may report continued investigation. We'll distinguish the update commitment from the unresolved service estimate.

06 • Customer operations manager: Please correct the original message in the same channel so our branch managers see it.

07 • Account service lead: I will, and I'll place the correction first rather than bury it beneath technical detail.

08 • Customer operations manager: Could you also make the time zone explicit? Our teams work in different regions.

09 • Account service lead: Yes. I'll use the agreed update time with its time zone and keep restoration status separate.

10 • Customer operations manager: That gives us a reliable communication plan even while the service investigation remains open.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A ticket closure did not resolve the complaint

Separate fictional case: a service ticket was administratively closed while the customer's recurring dropouts remained under a separate investigation; the closure message implied resolution.

01 • Customer care supervisor: Our closure message suggested the dropouts were resolved. That was inaccurate; the separate investigation remains open.

02 • Customer IT lead: Then why did we receive a message asking us to confirm that everything was fixed?

03 • Customer care supervisor: The message reflected the ticket workflow, not verified service recovery. We should have explained that distinction.

04 • Customer IT lead: Please don't make us restart the complaint just to keep the recurring fault visible.

05 • Customer care supervisor: I'll connect your complaint to the continuing investigation through our service assurance process and confirm the reference.

06 • Customer IT lead: Does that mean you know the root cause now, or only that someone is still investigating?

07 • Customer care supervisor: Only that the investigation continues. I won't imply that linking records establishes the cause.

08 • Customer IT lead: I need a clear owner and accurate status, not another generic resolved notification.

09 • Customer care supervisor: Understood. I'll correct the message and confirm ownership without promising an unverified repair or credit.

10 • Customer IT lead: Please do. That will help restore confidence that our actual service problem is being followed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Customer Churn and Service Recovery

A customer asks for an update after repeated service interruptions. The investigation has no confirmed root cause.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: I'm sorry the interruptions have continued. The cause is still under investigation. I'll summarize the verified service history and confirm the next update rather than repeat an unverified explanation.

Scenario 2 | A credit described as approved too early

A fictional support agent told a customer that an SLA credit was approved, but the record shows only a submitted review request. No amount or decision is confirmed. Correct the message and agree the next communication step.

Role A: You are the account service manager. Acknowledge the mistaken approval claim and explain the actual status.

Role B: You are the customer's finance coordinator. Ask whether you should adjust an internal invoice forecast.

Possible opening: I need to correct our earlier message: the credit was requested for review, not approved.

Success checks

- Acknowledge the communication error directly.
- Avoid inventing eligibility, approval, or an amount.
- Agree how the reviewed decision will be communicated.

Add a complication: The customer asks you to confirm a minimum credit amount immediately.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Purchase price versus the support horizon

The lesson's cheaper equipment proposal reaches end of support before the replacement plan ends; exact dates and prices are not supplied.

01 • Procurement manager: The lower purchase price looks attractive. Why shouldn't we choose that equipment for the capital plan?

02 • Network lifecycle lead: Its end-of-support date falls before the replacement plan ends, so price alone misses an important difference.

03 • Procurement manager: Does end of support mean the equipment will immediately stop working on that date?

04 • Network lifecycle lead: Not necessarily. We need the vendor's actual support terms and the implications for our planned use.

05 • Procurement manager: Then both proposals should be compared over the same operating period, including any replacement or support gap.

06 • Network lifecycle lead: Exactly. We should also compare interoperability evidence and spares availability rather than assume the devices are equivalent.

07 • Procurement manager: The cheaper option saves money initially, but may require a different lifecycle plan within our horizon.

08 • Network lifecycle lead: That's the tradeoff to investigate. We don't yet have enough information to quantify its full cost.

09 • Procurement manager: I'll request a common-period comparison and keep unconfirmed support arrangements out of the savings claim.

10 • Network lifecycle lead: I'll provide the lifecycle questions so the purchasing decision reflects the intended service period.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

New versus refurbished spares

Separate fictional case: a team compares new replacement units with refurbished units; refurbished units cost less, but compatibility testing and warranty terms remain unchecked.

01 • Spares coordinator: The refurbished batch costs less than new units, but its compatibility testing and warranty terms are unverified.

02 • Network engineering lead: Can we compare acquisition cost without presenting the refurbished units as proven replacements?

03 • Spares coordinator: Yes. I'll show the price difference separately from readiness and the remaining due-diligence questions.

04 • Network engineering lead: Interoperability matters here. A matching product family name doesn't establish behavior in our deployed configuration.

05 • Spares coordinator: Would you prefer the new units automatically, given that uncertainty around the refurbished batch?

06 • Network engineering lead: Not automatically. We need comparable configuration details, support terms, and test evidence for both options.

07 • Spares coordinator: Then the apparent saving trades against additional verification and possibly different support coverage.

08 • Network engineering lead: Correct, with the extent still unknown. We shouldn't invent failure rates to justify either choice.

09 • Spares coordinator: I'll obtain the missing records and compare both batches against the same spares requirements.

10 • Network engineering lead: I'll define the relevant acceptance checks so procurement can weigh the options on a consistent basis.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A phased replacement or one coordinated change

Separate fictional case: a capital plan considers replacing twenty access devices together or in four groups of five; mixed-version interoperability has not been tested.

01 • Capital planning manager: Replacing all twenty devices together concentrates the work, while four groups of five spread the change activity.

02 • Network architect: The phased approach also creates a mixed-version period. We haven't tested that interoperability yet.

03 • Capital planning manager: So spreading expenditure doesn't automatically make the phased option operationally easier or lower risk?

04 • Network architect: Correct. We need to compare change effort, support coverage, and the temporary mixed environment.

05 • Capital planning manager: What does the single-change option give up in exchange for avoiding that longer mixed period?

06 • Network architect: It concentrates deployment work into one coordinated event. We need to assess available resources for that scale.

07 • Capital planning manager: Neither approach has an approved schedule yet, so I'll avoid claiming one meets a fixed completion date.

08 • Network architect: Good. Include spares and rollback planning in the comparison, without treating either plan as already validated.

09 • Capital planning manager: I'll present the two sequences against the same service horizon and list the unresolved resource questions.

10 • Network architect: I'll arrange the interoperability assessment needed to judge whether the phased option is viable.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Vendor and Equipment Lifecycle

One equipment proposal has a lower purchase price but an earlier end-of-support date. The replacement plan extends beyond that date.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The lower price comes with a shorter support period. Let's compare the expected service life, support needs, and replacement timing before making the investment recommendation.

Scenario 2 | Support renewal or accelerated replacement

A fictional vendor offers one more year of support for existing equipment. Replacement equipment is available, but migration effort is not estimated. Compare renewal with replacement across the same one-year horizon without claiming either is cheaper overall.

Role A: You are the lifecycle manager. Explain the known support offer and missing migration information.

Role B: You are the capital planning lead. Ask about cost, operational effort, and what each option postpones or changes.

Possible opening: The support extension covers one year, but we need the migration estimate before comparing total costs.

Success checks

- Use the same one-year comparison period.
- Distinguish known fees from unestimated migration costs.
- State the tradeoff and identify the evidence needed for a decision.

Add a complication: A colleague treats the support fee as wasted money without considering replacement work.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-06. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Rehearse with an AI colleague

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Telecommunications English

Professional audience: network operations staff, telecom engineers, field technicians, customer operations teams, product managers, regulatory staff, and telecom project leaders

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Dialogue 01: Outage bridge

Original fictional setting: Network operations coordinates a service interruption.

Professional roles: NOC engineer / Incident coordinator

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

NOC engineer: We have loss-of-signal alarms on the eastern ring. Several enterprise circuits are affected.

Incident coordinator: Do we have a confirmed fault location or only correlated alarms?

NOC engineer: Only the alarms so far. Field verification is pending.

Incident coordinator: Keep the suspected cause separate from confirmed impact. Who owns field coordination?

NOC engineer: The duty field supervisor. I'll provide circuit IDs and the latest topology information.

Incident coordinator: I'll maintain the incident timeline and issue the next update without inventing a restoration time.

Vocabulary in this exchange: circuit: A telecommunications connection or path used to carry a service.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Interactive workplace role-play

1. Use the supplied case or dialogue as the starting situation. Give a two-sentence briefing and offer two relevant professional roles for me to choose from. For a supplied dialogue, use its actual roles. Ask which role I want, then stop and wait. Do not write my replies.
2. After I choose, identify who you will play and the immediate communication goal. Play the other professional; where a meeting requires a third person, label each of your speakers clearly. Start with one natural workplace turn and wait for my reply. Keep most turns to one to three sentences and ask no more than one question at a time.
3. Let the exchange develop across six to ten learner turns, or end earlier if I type "feedback". Respond to what I actually say. Include a plausible clarification, disagreement or tradeoff without silently changing the starting facts. Mark any added constraint as a fictional second-round variation. Do not resolve approvals, evidence or commitments that remain uncertain.
4. Stay in role during the exchange. If my meaning is unclear, ask for clarification naturally. Give a hint only if I ask or cannot proceed. Do not deliver a model conversation in advance.
5. At the debrief, quote two of my phrases: one successful choice and one worth improving. Check factual accuracy, language, register and whether the next step was clear. Give up to three focused suggestions. Ask me to retry the weakest turn; wait. Only then offer an alternative wording and a harder replay.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Create more scenario dialogues

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Telecommunications English

Professional audience: network operations staff, telecom engineers, field technicians, customer operations teams, product managers, regulatory staff, and telecom project leaders

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Dialogue 01: Outage bridge

Original fictional setting: Network operations coordinates a service interruption.

Professional roles: NOC engineer / Incident coordinator

Published dialogue (reference script, not my own performance):

NOC engineer: We have loss-of-signal alarms on the eastern ring. Several enterprise circuits are affected.

Incident coordinator: Do we have a confirmed fault location or only correlated alarms?

NOC engineer: Only the alarms so far. Field verification is pending.

Incident coordinator: Keep the suspected cause separate from confirmed impact. Who owns field coordination?

NOC engineer: The duty field supervisor. I'll provide circuit IDs and the latest topology information.

Incident coordinator: I'll maintain the incident timeline and issue the next update without inventing a restoration time.

Vocabulary in this exchange: circuit: A telecommunications connection or path used to carry a service.

END REFERENCE**TASK: Extend the conversation library**

1. Propose six distinct, common scenarios in this field beyond the supplied case or script. For each, name the setting, two or more professional roles, the communication problem and one useful terminology focus. Include routine coordination, clarification, a complication, disagreement, handoff and follow-up where relevant. Choose scenarios that fit this profession, rather than forcing unsuitable situations into it.
2. Ask me to choose one scenario, or request all six in sequence. Stop and wait. Do not write all the scripts before I choose.
3. For the selected scenario, write an original fictional dialogue of 12-18 substantial speaking turns between two or three professionals. Name each role, establish an actual work problem, and let the exchange progress through questions, clarification, competing constraints and a credible next step or explicitly unresolved issue. Use the occupation's natural nomenclature and register. Avoid an interview between a teacher and a learner, generic small talk, and inserting a glossary definition into every reply. Explain specialist terms outside the dialogue instead.
4. After the script, explain five useful expressions in context, identify two grammar or register choices and ask three questions about the speakers' reasoning. Withhold the answers until I attempt them. Add one role-switch challenge.
5. Before presenting a script, check names, numbers, chronology, roles and terminology for consistency. Label invented facts and acknowledge uncertain specialist usage. If I requested all six, deliver one complete script at a time and wait for "next". Make each scenario materially different.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level